

Experiment No. 2: Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface

1. Aim

To configure and examine the Zoho Creator environment by developing a Student Attendance Management application, creating data-entry forms and reports, preparing a dashboard, and understanding the purpose of the Develop, Deploy and Manage sections.

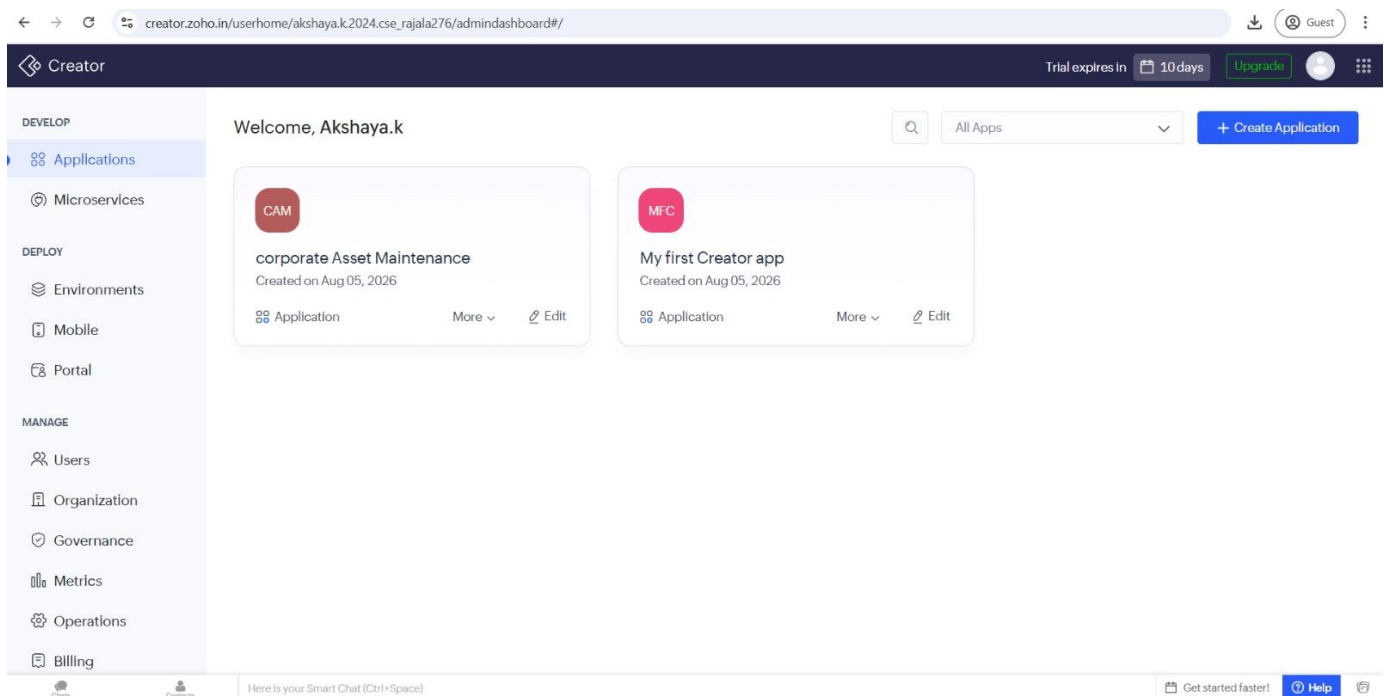
2. Setting up Zoho Creator

A Zoho Creator application named Student Attendance Management was planned to maintain student details, class information, attendance records and attendance summaries in one application.

The application was organized using the following forms:

- 1. Student Profile** – Stores student ID, name, department, year, section and contact details.
- 2. Class Details** – Maintains class code, subject name, faculty name, room and timetable information.
- 3. Attendance Entry** – Records the attendance status of students for a selected class, subject and date.
- 4. Faculty Details** – Stores faculty ID, faculty name, department, designation and assigned subjects.
- 5. Leave Request** – Records student leave applications with date, reason and approval status.
- 6. Attendance Review** – Tracks attendance summaries and identifies students who require attention.

Sample Application: Student Attendance Management



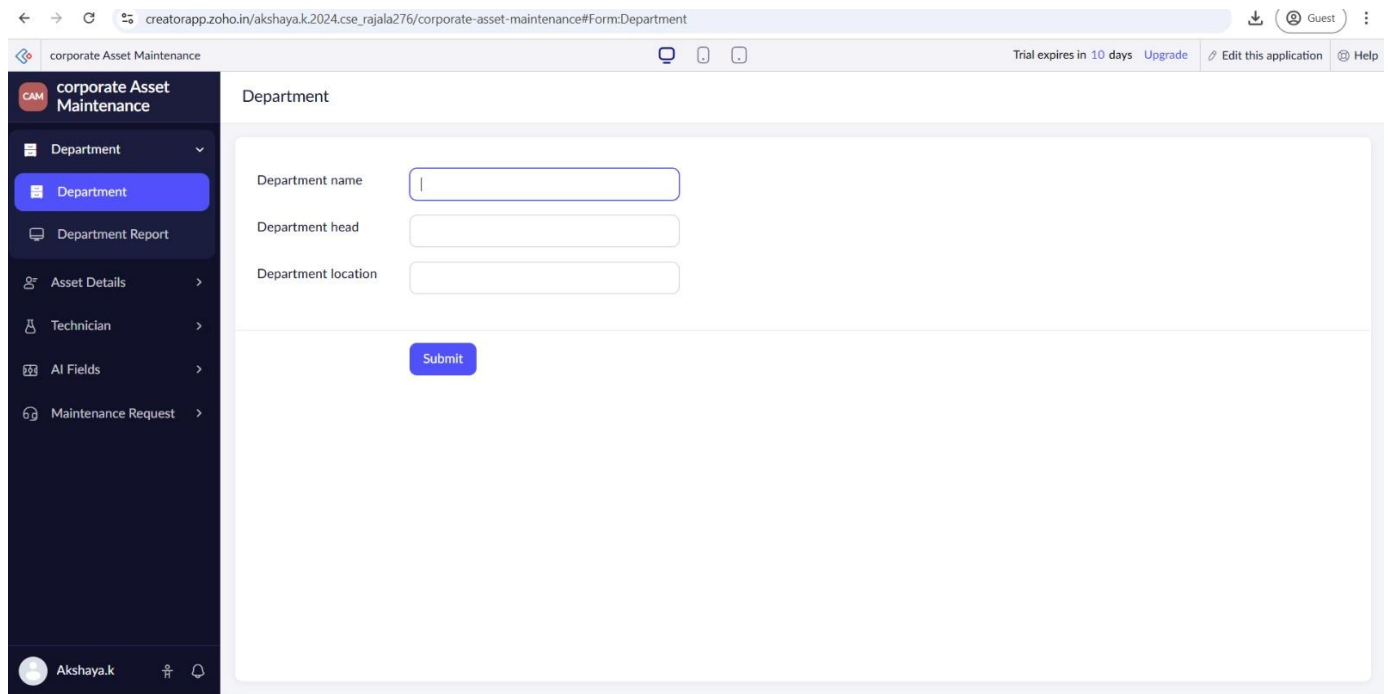
A. Creating Form

A form in Zoho Creator is used to collect information in a structured manner. Each field represents a particular piece of information, and submitted entries are stored as application records.

For this application, the Student Profile form can be used to collect student information such as student ID, student name, department, year, section, phone number and email address.

Explanation

The form divides student information into separate fields, which keeps records clear and consistent. After a user submits the form, the entry is stored in Zoho Creator and can be used in reports, dashboards and workflows.

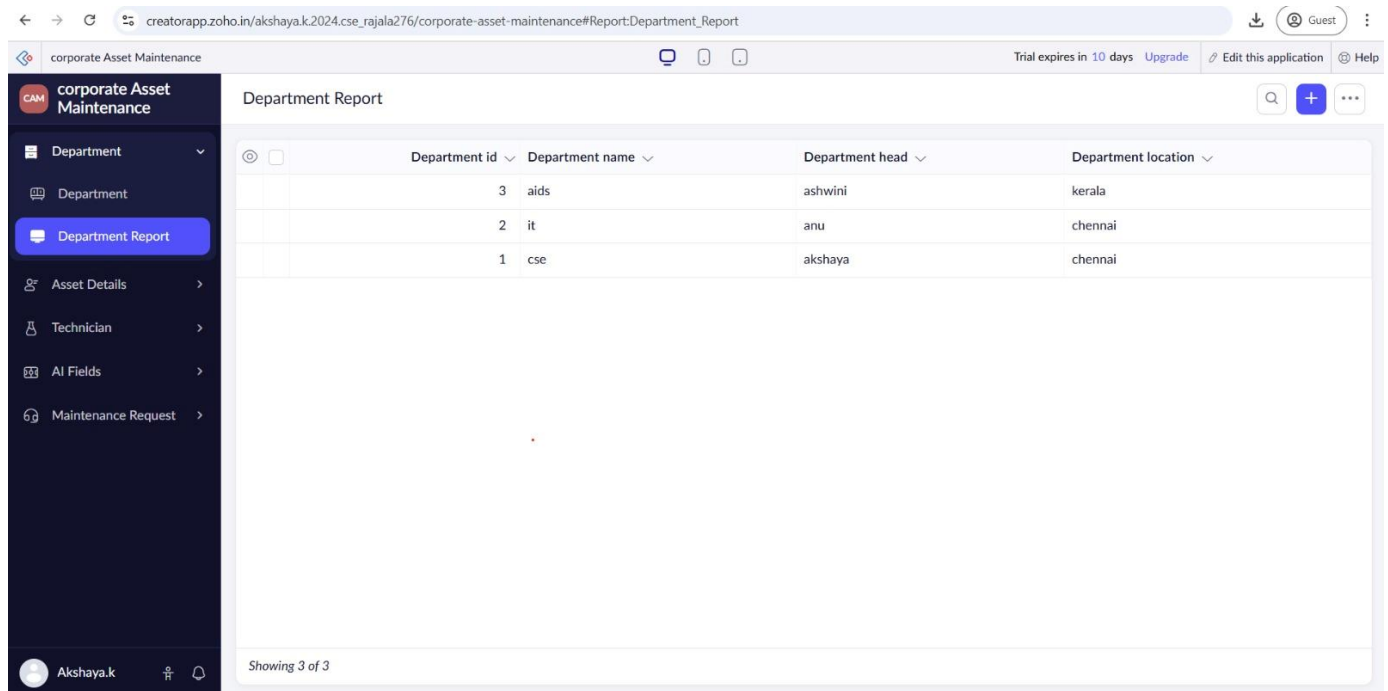


The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator interface for a form titled "Department". The browser address bar shows the URL: `creatorapp.zoho.in/akshaya.k.2024.cse_rajala276/corporate-asset-maintenance#Form:Department`. The application header includes the title "corporate Asset Maintenance", a user profile for "Guest", and a trial expiration notice: "Trial expires in 10 days". The left sidebar menu lists several options: "Department" (selected), "Department Report", "Asset Details", "Technician", "AI Fields", and "Maintenance Request". The main content area, titled "Department", contains three input fields: "Department name", "Department head", and "Department location". A blue "Submit" button is positioned below these fields. The bottom status bar shows the user "Akshaya.k" and standard mobile navigation icons.

B. Creating Report

A report displays the records collected through a form in an organized view. It helps users search, sort and review information without opening every individual form entry.

The Attendance Report can be created from the Attendance Entry form. It may display student ID, student name, date, subject, class, attendance status and remarks.



Department id	Department name	Department head	Department location
3	aids	ashwini	kerala
2	it	anu	chennai
1	cse	akshaya	chennai

Explanation

The report brings attendance records together in a single searchable view. Faculty members can quickly check daily attendance, identify absentees and review records for a particular subject or date.

C. Creating Dashboard

A dashboard provides a compact visual summary of important application information. It allows users to understand attendance activity quickly by displaying key totals and summaries.

The Student Attendance Dashboard can display:

- Total Students
- Classes Conducted
- Students Present Today
- Students Absent Today
- Students with Low Attendance

Explanation

The dashboard gives faculty and administrators a quick overview of attendance performance. Its values can change automatically when new attendance records are added or existing records are updated.

3. Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

A. Develop

1. The Develop area is used to create and customize the components of a Zoho Creator application.
2. It supports the creation of forms, reports, pages, workflows and dashboards.
3. Deluge scripting can be used to add validations, calculations, automation and application logic.

B. Deploy

1. The Deploy area is used to make the completed application available to its intended users.
2. The application can be accessed through supported web and mobile experiences.
3. User access and permissions can be configured according to different roles.

C. Manage

1. The Manage area supports administration and maintenance of the application after it is created.
2. It provides controls for users, permissions, data, application settings and integrations.
3. Administrators can monitor the application configuration and update it when requirements change.

Result

Thus, the Student Attendance Management application was configured and explored successfully in Zoho Creator. The experiment demonstrated the creation of forms and reports, the use of a dashboard for attendance summaries, and the purpose of the Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the platform.

Conclusion: Zoho Creator provides an integrated environment for collecting data, presenting records, monitoring application information and managing access to an application.